

Chicago Tribune



QUESTIONS? CALL 1-800-TRIBUNE

WEDNESDAY, MARCH 26, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

President, aides downplay plan leak

Trump calls release ‘glitch’; Senate grills intelligence officials

By David Klepper and Aamer Madhani
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — President Donald Trump on Tuesday downplayed the texting of sensitive plans for a military strike against Yemen’s Houthis this month to a group chat that included a journalist, saying it was “the only glitch in two months” of his administration as Democratic lawmakers heaped criticism on the administration for

handling highly sensitive information carelessly.
Trump told NBC News that the lapse “turned out not to be a serious one,” and articulated his continued support for national security adviser Mike Waltz, who mistakenly added the editor-in-chief of The Atlantic, Jeffrey Goldberg, to the chain that included 18 senior administration officials discussing planning for the strike.
“Michael Waltz has learned a lesson, and he’s a good man,”

Trump said. He also appeared to assign blame to an unnamed Waltz aide for Goldberg being added to the chain. “It was one of Michael’s people on the phone. A staffer had his number on there.”
But the use of messaging app Signal to discuss a sensitive operation has opened the administration to blistering criticism from Democratic lawmakers who expressed outrage at the White House’s and

Turn to Leak, Page 5



FBI Director Kash Patel, left, intelligence chief Tulsi Gabbard and CIA head John Ratcliffe on Tuesday. J. SCOTT APPLEWHITE/AP



The Toyota Celica of Karen Schepers is loaded onto a flatbed truck after being taken out of the Fox River on Tuesday in Elgin. STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Crews recover car of Elgin woman missing since 1983

Toyota Celica discovered northwest of Slade Avenue boat launch on the Fox River

By Gloria Casas
Chicago Tribune

A car belonging to an Elgin woman whose 1983 disappearance became the subject of a law enforcement podcast was pulled from the Fox River on Tuesday afternoon.
Authorities said the recovered Toyota Celica had a license plate identical to the one registered to 23-year-old Karen Schepers, who went missing nearly 42 years ago after spending an evening with co-workers.
The Kane County Coroner’s

Office will examine the vehicle to determine whether any human remains are inside, Elgin Police Chief Ana Lalley said.
“This is the beginning of what is still an open and active investigation with many questions still to be answered,” Lalley said. “As we continue to investigate this case, we will remain steadfast in our resolve to provide answers and closure for Karen’s family.”
Covered in mud and branches, the car was discovered in a spot northwest of the Slade Avenue boat launch. It was located by Chaos Divers, a nonprofit that

specializes in finding missing people in bodies of water.
Working with two Elgin police detectives, the team spent the day Monday systematically looking at locations where the car could have gone in during the early morning hours of April 16, 1983, when Schepers was last seen leaving a bar in Carpentersville and was believed to be returning home to Elgin.
Four decades later, Schepers’ disappearance became the subject of a podcast, “Somebody Knows Something,” put together by Elgin Cold Case Unit detec-

tives Andrew Houghton and Matt Vartanian, who looked at different theories about the unsolved mystery. They requested the search be done as part of their investigation.
Chaos Divers manager Lindsay Bussick, joined in the search by company owner Jacob Grubbs and diver Mike McFerron, said Monday they were exploring several locations where an accident could have occurred. Their initial search focused on parts of the river that run alongside

Turn to Car, Page 4

Raoul pushes for more funding

AG’s office girding for legal battles with Trump administration

By Olivia Olander
Chicago Tribune

Illinois Attorney General Kwame Raoul is pushing for additional funding for his office as it takes on a host of lawsuits and legal filings against actions by the Trump administration.
“What we want to make clear to the legislature is that we’re a good investment, right? And it’s not a time to disinvest in our office,” Raoul said in an interview.
Illinois was facing a tight budget year even before President Donald Trump assumed office, and now faces the additional threat of federal funding cuts. And since Trump arrived at the White House, Raoul’s office has partnered with dozens of other states in a series of lawsuits on issues ranging from birthright citizenship to mass layoffs at the Department of Education that he and other attorneys general argue violate the law or U.S. Constitution.
Raoul said the budget proposal Gov. JB Pritzker’s office put forth in February would not provide the attorney general’s office with enough money to keep up with ongoing litigation against the Trump administration and an expected retreat by the federal government on civil rights, consumer protection and anti-trust enforcement.
The governor’s office proposed \$106 million for the attorney’s general from the general revenue fund in fiscal 2026, according to its budget book. That’s almost \$15 million less than the approximately \$120 million the AG’s office wants, which is the general revenue fund total proposed in appropriations legislation filed

Turn to Funding, Page 4

Small number of voters will decide

Some suburban voters are facing key decisions about hiking property taxes in the April 1 election, but if the past is precedent, “the few will decide for the many” again, according to a report from Cook County Treasurer Maria Pappas’ office. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Trump cuts hitting farms, food banks

President Donald Trump’s federal funding cuts are being felt from farms in the heartland to food banks in Chicago. More than \$1 billion in aid that helps local farmers, schools and food banks has vanished. **Business**

Boutros, a former fed and ‘go-getter,’ on cusp of being named interim US attorney in Chicago

By Jason Meisner and Rick Pearson
Chicago Tribune

Veteran Chicago lawyer and former federal prosecutor Andrew Boutros is expected to be appointed by the Trump administration to serve as interim U.S. attorney for the Northern District of Illinois, sources told the Tribune.
Boutros, 47, now the co-chair of the government investigations and white collar group at Shook Hardy & Bacon LLP in Chicago, was among those vetted for the White House by U.S. Rep. Darin LaHood, a Peoria Republican,

who conducted several rounds of interviews over the past month, several sources familiar with the process said.
The sources told the Tribune that Boutros was not among those LaHood recommended for the position, however. LaHood instead forwarded the names of two other former assistant U.S. attorneys, Jeffrey Cramer and Mark Schneider, as well as Brendan O’Leary, an ex-Cook County prosecutor and FBI special agent who headed the public corruption squad in Chicago, according to sources.
President Donald Trump’s administration selected Boutros

after LaHood met with senior members of the administration last week, the sources said.
The move had not been formally announced by the Trump administration as of Tuesday. A Department of Justice spokesperson did not respond to emails seeking comment.
Reached by phone Tuesday, Boutros declined to comment.
Boutros’ appointment would bring some stability to the office more than two years after John Lausch stepped down as Chicago’s top federal prosecutor.
By giving Boutros interim



Boutros

status, the White House bypasses the immediate need for Boutros to be confirmed by the U.S. Senate. That process would kick in once the Trump administration selects someone for the permanent post.
Either way, Boutros is expected to inject new energy into an office that has long been considered one of the best in the country but has seen productivity and morale slip in recent years.
Known as a diligent attorney and an extremely hard worker,

Turn to Boutros, Page 2

